



NPCI-G **CULTURE** **PLAYBOOK**

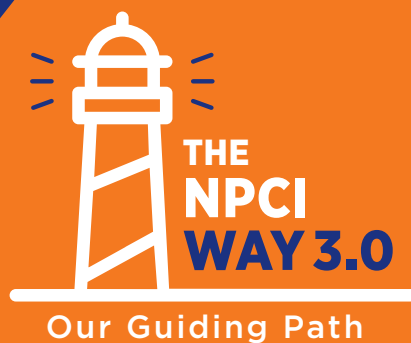


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1.0 Introduction

NPCI-G Culture Playbook is reference document guiding all NPCI-G employees to understand and appreciate the organizational culture and its values. It is a dynamic and evolving guide that defines who an organization is, what it stands for, and how it operates. It provides clarity on values, behaviours, and principles that shape the company's identity and guide employees in their day-to-day actions.

2.0 NPCI MD & CEO's Message

"The culture of the organisation is as good as their leaders and their character. The Character of the leader decides what the organisation and their teams behave and do. We as leaders are going to hold each other accountable to create the NPCI 3.0 culture."

3.0 Vision and Mission

VISION

LEAD THE FUTURE OF
**DIGITAL
PAYMENTS**
TO TRANSFORM LIVES
GLOBALLY

MISSION

TO CREATE AND SCALE FUTURE READY
**PAYMENTS
SYSTEM**
THROUGH NEW AGE
TECH INNOVATION

4.0 Our Culture Statement: NPCI WAY

At NPCI, culture is our collective mindset and behaviour that defines how we work, why we do what we do, and how we show up every day - as individuals, teams, and as one organization. It is the invisible guiding path that binds us, guiding decisions, and driving performance. **NPCI WAY** is our unique cultural blueprint - it represents the principles, values, and behaviours that enable us to thrive in a fast-evolving, technology-driven world. Staying always forward requires everyone to be dynamic, adaptive, and future-ready and embedding our values into the fabric of our work culture.

NPCI WAY is shaped through continuous feedback across levels, built on our core foundation, and championed by leaders. It reflects our commitment to the purpose of Nation Building and providing public good through innovation, empowerment, accountability, and collaboration to build the best-cultured, best performance-driven organization. Every employee is a custodian of our culture. To align with our strategic goals and foster an inclusive, innovative, and high-performance workplace.

4.1 The five core tenets of **NPCI WAY** that Guide us



FORWARD THINKING MINDSET | INNOVATION is the game changer

Dream big, solve difficult problems. Take risks, fail fast-learn fast.

We're always looking forward - curious, bold, and ready to take calculated risks. It's about experimenting, trying new ideas, and learning quickly when things don't go as planned, embracing real perseverance. We aim to solve complex challenges with creativity and courage. Every step we take today towards a bold

dream, shapes a smarter tomorrow. Even if we stumble, we get back up, refine our approach, and keep moving. The goal is to stay open to change, embrace the unknown, and never stop improving. Progress starts with a mindset that's hungry to explore what's next.



ALL SUCCEED TOGETHER | TOGETHER we win, with EMPATHY

Collaborate as one team, vibe with trust, respect each other's views and listen with intent.

We believe great things happen when people connect, support one another, and work with mutual understanding. It's about building strong relationships - with teammates, customers, and partners - by being honest, respectful, and open-minded. Everyone's voice matters and

listening with care helps us learn and grow. We're stronger when we lift each other up and move forward as a unit. By being kind, curious, and real with each other, we create a space where everyone has a chance to do their best and feel valued. Success is sweeter when it's shared.



CUSTOMER FIRST | CUSTOMER is the real MVP

Champion customers, spot their needs proactively, deliver experience, glow up their game.

The people we serve are at the heart of everything we do. Understanding what they need—even before they ask—is key to making their experience better. It's not just about meeting expectations but going the extra mile to make a real difference in

their journey. Every interaction is a chance to build trust and create value. When we focus on helping them grow, we grow too. Staying tuned in to their world helps us build better products, smarter solutions, and stronger relationships that last.



PASSION TO DELIVER | OWN the MOVE

Take charge, own your actions, be agile and adapt quickly. Make things happen.

For us, bias for action is fundamental. Recognizing the balance between swift action and efficient execution are pivotal to delivery. Getting things done is about showing energy, taking responsibility, and pushing through challenges with determination. When change happens, we stay flexible and adjust fast. It's not always easy,

but we take pride in seeing things through from start to finish. We care deeply about the outcome and give it our all, every time by making prompt and informed decisions. This tenet also defines our commitment to achieving results and effectively, driving our organization forward in a dynamic and competitive landscape.



LEAD WITH PURPOSE | PURPOSE beyond self

Prioritize impact over individual success; deliver despite challenging circumstances.

Our core ethos revolves around the central theme of contributing to nation and society at large, catalysing the transformative growth journey. We have our unwavering focus on impact over profits and fostering a deep sense of pride in being a part of this nation-building endeavour. It's about putting the bigger picture above personal gain. It means

making choices that matter—not just for today, but for the long haul. Even when the path is unclear or difficult, we stay focused on the impact we want to create. We lift others, stay grounded in what's important, and follow through no matter what. Purpose gives our work meaning and helps us build something that truly counts.

FORWARD THINKING MINDSET

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INNOVATION is the game changer



CUSTOMER FIRST

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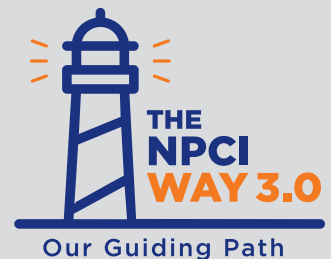
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TOGETHER we win, with EMPATHY



THE FIVE THAT GUIDE US



PASSION TO DELIVER

Take charge, own your actions, be agile, adapt quickly and make things happen

OWN the MOVE



LEAD WITH PURPOSE

Prioritize impact over individual success, deliver despite challenging circumstances

PURPOSE beyond self



4.2 Leadership Credo

The culture of an organisation is a direct reflection of its leaders and their character. The way leaders behave and conduct themselves shapes how teams perform, engage, and collaborate. At NPCI-G, leaders are expected to uphold and role-model the tenets thereby fostering a culture of trust, accountability, and respect.

To bring this to life, it is essential to have a clear and actionable commitment from leaders that defines what inspirational leadership looks like. **Leadership Credo – Leadership Promises (Dos) and Behaviours (Don'ts)** outlines these expectations. It serves as a collective responsibility for all NPCI-G leaders to lead by example and embody the values we stand for.

LEADERSHIP CREDO

FORWARD THINKING MINDSET

- Set ambitious goals to push boundaries
- Create safe space to learn from mistakes



- Don't reject ideas without deliberation
- Avoid bias in decision making

ALL SUCCEED TOGETHER

- Strengthen relationship to shift from "I" to "We"
- Celebrate cross functional team success



- Don't criticize in public
- Don't be dismissive/disrespectful

CUSTOMER FIRST

- Build meaningful partnership
- Offer experience relevant to customer



- Don't be reactive, anticipate needs
- Avoid assumptions without feedback/data

PASSION TO DELIVER

- Encourage independent decision-making
- Share goals and priorities transparently



- Don't label everything urgent
- Avoid always micro-manage

LEAD WITH PURPOSE

- Communicate the "Why"
- Recognize mission-aligned behaviours



- Avoid me-first behaviour
- Don't over emphasis on short term result

✓ Leadership Promises (Dos)

✗ Leadership Behaviours (Don'ts)

5.0 Culture Communication

To truly embed culture across the organization, it is essential that every individual not only understands but also consistently experiences and live NPCI WAY in their daily work. Engagement at all levels ensures that culture is not just a top-down directive, but a shared responsibility driven by collective ownership.

5.1 Clear and Consistent Communication

Reinforce cultural messages through multiple platforms—town halls, all hands meet – deep talk sessions, internal meetings, leadership communication, etc.

In addition to leadership communication, HR to have a regular engagement plan to ensure proper communication, understanding and assimilation of the organizational values by all the employees.

5.2 Integration into Core Practices

Embed cultural elements in key people processes and practices like onboarding, performance management, rewards, and recognition etc. HR function to ensure a strong integration in the people processes such that the experience is robust and standard across the organization.

Process Category

Embed in Workflows

Rewards and Recognition	Recognize and celebrate employees who are consistently demonstrate NPCI WAY tenets in their actions and behaviours
Talent Acquisition	The NPCI WAY tenets as a key behavioural criterion to assess the “Culture Fit” of candidate/s during hiring process
Employee Onboarding	Integrate NPCI WAY tenets deeply into the onboarding orientation to instil cultural alignment
Performance Management	Enable Leaders /People Managers to provide continuous feedback to team members on the NPCI WAY alignment. Clearly communicate the areas of strength and improvement related to values
Talent Management	Design development and upskilling interventions with a strong emphasis on NPCI WAY tenets to build and strengthen talent for for today and future
Employee Engagement	Employee Engagement initiatives around creating a culture that reflects and reinforces the NPCI WAY
Any other People Processes	Embed NPCI WAY as the foundation across all practices

6.0 Feedback Mechanism to reinforce organizational values

At NPCI-G, values are considered meaningful guide to drive the desired organization culture only when they are understood, assimilated, and consistently practiced across the organization. To assess the depth of cultural adoption, a structured feedback mechanism has been established. This mechanism enables the organization to measure cultural alignment, identify gaps, and take informed action.

1 Understanding of NPCI WAY

Feedback is collected to gauge how well employees understand the organizational values. This includes their awareness of what each value stands for, how it applies to their roles, and how they are expected to embody these values in daily work. This feedback is to be captured through periodic culture audits, pulse surveys, and feedback sessions conducted across teams.

2 Observing values come alive in organizational behaviours and actions

Culture is reinforced when employees observe values being practiced by all the employees, seniors, peers, colleagues, etc. in day to day working. Such observations are gathered through regular formal feedback mechanisms.

3 Leadership Role Model of values

Leaders play the most important role in shaping and sustaining the organizational culture. Two channels to assess whether leaders are consistently living the NPCI-G values

3.1 Annual 360-Degree Feedback

Each leader undergoes a comprehensive feedback process to evaluate the extent to which they exhibit value-based behaviours and are demonstrating the NPCI Way tenets, as perceived by peers, team members, and other stakeholders.

3.2 Continuous Behavioural Monitoring

Beyond annual feedback, behavioural trends are continuously monitored through various touchpoints - employee connect, employee pulse etc received throughout the year. Especially for instances where the leaders' actions are not true to the Leadership Credo, it is important to have a formal feedback mechanism that enables employees to express their concerns in a safe and confidential manner.

Table 1.0 Feedback Mechanism Summary Table

Feedback Touchpoints	Objective of the mechanism	Methodology	Timelines
NPCI Way Survey	Understanding of tenets Observing the tenets in behaviours and actions	Online survey Feedback to HR	Annual / Semi-annual As and when required
Leadership Score – Walk the Talk	Leaders demonstrating Role Model Behaviour as per Leadership Credo	360-degree feedback process Feedback to HR / Ethics Committee / A dedicated email Id - npci.way@npci.org.in	Annual As and when required

7.0 Actions based on the feedback gathered

Based on the feedback received through various touch points the following actions are designed. These actions aim to recognize employees who embody Organizational culture and address gaps in alignment with the same.

Recognition for Exemplary Behaviours

Leaders and employees consistently demonstrating the NPCI WAY in their daily work to be acknowledged and celebrated through a structured recognition framework via initiatives such as culture champions or peer-to-peer recognition programs etc.

Table 2.0 Reward and RecognitionTable

Value Alignment	Indicative Behavior	Reward and Recognition
LEVEL 1	Demonstrates organizational values in day-to-day responsibilities	Recognition on online recognition platform / In person at departmental level
LEVEL 2	Demonstrates values beyond the immediate team, especially in cross-functional initiatives	Recognition on Appreciation Wall (physical / digital) with employee showcase / Recommendation for professional development courses (as appropriate)
LEVEL 3	Displaying organizational values on strategic, high-impact initiatives/ projects with lasting business impact	Recognition at Family level/ Felicitation at organizational events

(This is an indicative and not an exhaustive list of Rewards and Recognition)

Interventions for Addressing Culture Gaps

- If feedback highlights gaps in understanding of values or expected behaviour by employees, more focus on the periodic awareness and communication campaigns, leadership talks and internal or organizational level connect events on culture to be conducted. HR to design relevant interventions.
- If employees observe misalignment between actions and values by leaders or peers in day to day working; they should report / escalated to HR / Ethics Committee / Culture Committee for appropriate action, progressive steps may be taken based on the severity and recurrence of the issue under Leadership Credo Compliance framework.



Table 3.0 Leadership Credo Compliance Framework

Misalignment	Indicative Examples of Behaviour	Leadership Credo Compliance Action
LEVEL - 1	First instance of behavioural slip as defined in Leadership Credo	Informal Counselling: - One-on-one meeting/feedback discussion by HR along with reporting manager - HR to document as informal conversation with specific examples/conversation
LEVEL - 2	Repeated instances of behavioural slip as defined in Leadership Credo	Formal written advisory - Action plans to address behaviour within 30-60 days' timeline - Written Warning / Formal Coaching to work on deeper disconnects - Documented in employee file as a learning intervention
LEVEL - 3	Continued behavioural violations after prior levels or major breach	Final written warning or performance improvement plan (PIP): - Escalated to senior leadership or Ethics Committee for resolution - Impact on appraisal, bonus, or leadership opportunities.

(This is an indicative and not an exhaustive list of misalignments and the equivalent actions)

8.0 Culture Governance and Continuous Improvement

Culture governance and continuous improvement are pivotal to sustaining a thriving organizational culture that NPCI-G envisaged. By embedding clear accountability, regular feedback loops, and mechanisms to measure cultural alignment, organizations can ensure their values are consistently upheld. A strong governance framework fosters ownership at all levels, while a commitment to continuous improvement ensures the culture remains dynamic, inclusive, and responsive to changing business needs. Together, they create a resilient foundation for long-term success and employee engagement.

9.0 Annual Review

NPCI-G Culture Playbook to be reviewed once every year to ensure the process and guidelines defined in the document are effective and in alignment to the organizational priorities and imperatives.

THANK YOU

“ **Together we move,
Always Forward** ”



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In case of any inputs / suggestions / queries, pls connect with HR Transformation Design & Planning team or write to us at npci.way@npci.org.in